C-store was a big unlock #businessgrowth #motivation #sucessjourney #successboost #mindset #greglav

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📋 Executive Summary

Bloom Energy Drink broke into convenience stores after 18 slow months, defying skeptics who doubted a purple, non-traditional drink could sell there, and became the fastest-growing energy drink in c-stores for 2026.

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🏪 Bloom's Convenience Store Entry Challenge 0:00

- Bloom products had **never been in convenience stores** before the energy drink launch
  - Prior Bloom product line included: green supplements, pre-workout, and Bloom protein
  - The energy drink represented a new retail channel entirely
- Growth in c-stores started very slowly
  - A key structural reason: many convenience stores are owned by franchise operators
    - Franchise owners tend to resist change and new, unproven products
  - The team had to persist gradually — "take their time and prove it through sales"
- The process required **18 full months** of patience before meaningful traction appeared

📈 Turning the Corner: Becoming the Fastest-Growing Energy Drink 0:23

- One year ago, industry skeptics argued a purple energy drink could not succeed in c-stores
  - The conventional belief: c-stores serve blue-collar male workers
  - A purple, lifestyle-oriented drink was seen as misaligned with that core customer
- Two demographic shifts changed the equation:
  - More women are now shopping at convenience stores
  - More men have started drinking Bloom

- Together these two trends made Bloom the **fastest-growing energy drink in convenience stores for 2026**

> The biggest insight: patience plus proof-through-sales over 18 months unlocked a channel that conventional wisdom said was the wrong fit entirely.